

Chapter 15 Test Answers *TR 15.10A*

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

1. Salvation is . . .
 - a. earned by practicing spiritual disciplines.
 - b. a free gift from God.**
 - c. freedom to do what we want.
 - d. based on how good we are.
 - e. God's grace to us.
2. Choose all that are true of spiritual disciplines.
 - a. They help us grow and mature to become like Christ.**
 - b. They help form us into people who can live well and rule well in God's kingdom.**
 - c. They involve trying to achieve God's favor.
 - d. They involve hard work to put ourselves in a place where God can work in our hearts.
3. The spiritual disciplines that require quiet time include . . .
 - a. silence and solitude.**
 - b. simplicity and stewardship.
 - c. listening and self-examination.**
 - d. transcendence exercises to reach higher spiritual consciousness.
 - e. worship and fasting.
 - f. praise and group Bible study.
4. Asceticism is . . .
 - a. a belief in an unknown higher power.
 - b. taking a vow of silence.
 - c. the practice of avoiding all forms of indulgence.**
 - d. the heretical teaching that Jesus was only a divine being created by the Father.
 - e. practicing the spiritual disciplines.
5. A steward is . . .
 - a. a spiritual leader over others.
 - b. something Christians are called to be.**
 - c. a person who works hard to build a career.
 - d. one who cares for and manages what belongs to another.
6. Which is not one of the three biblical fasts?
 - a. Defining Moment Fast
 - b. Tragic Calamity Fast
 - c. Rejoicing in God Fast**
 - d. Turning from Sinful Choices Fast



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7. Generosity is about . . .
 - a. just giving money to needy people.
 - b. giving of our resources, time, and talent.
 - c. budgeting money carefully.
 - d. giving to others so God will bless us in return.
8. Fasting is . . .
 - a. a kind of dieting.
 - b. something only the spiritually elite do.
 - c. an attempt to earn God's favor or forgiveness.
 - d. a response to what God is doing in our lives.
9. Christians should read . . .
 - a. only books we agree with.
 - b. a variety of books, including ones by authors we disagree with.
 - c. only the Bible and *The Book of Common Prayer*.
 - d. only books by Christian authors.
10. Choose all that accurately describe reading by "inviting" the author into conversation.
 - a. ignoring parts of the author's argument that you disagree with
 - b. making a generous effort to understand the author's perspective
 - c. challenging the author where appropriate
 - d. believing everything the author says without further research
 - e. treating the author with respect even when you don't agree
11. Simplicity is important so we can . . .
 - a. enjoy mystical experiences with God or the divine.
 - b. seek God's kingdom first.
 - c. follow Simeon Stylites' example.
 - d. gain favor with God.
12. Choose all that are examples of written prayers.
 - a. *The Book of Common Prayer*
 - b. Genesis
 - c. the Psalms
 - d. *The Valley of Vision*
13. To fast is to . . .
 - a. intentionally abstain from food and drink for a set time.
 - b. refrain from doing something.
 - c. attend church regularly.
 - d. go without food to make yourself more spiritual.

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14. Choose all statements that are true about prayer.
- a. Prayer is about a relationship with God.
 - b. Prayer is about expecting God to answer my prayers the way I'd like.
 - c. Prayer doesn't always yield immediate results.
 - d. Prayer is another duty to perform.

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

T 15. To abstain means to refrain from doing something. _____

T 16. Memorization helps us internalize God's Word. _____

F 17. Asceticism is one of the primary Christian motivations for work. generosity

T 18. When Tasha rejects the need to have the latest and greatest things and reevaluates possessions that keep her from seeking God's kingdom first, she is practicing simplicity.

F 19. Prayer is reflecting on God's Word. Christian meditation

T 20. The Bible challenges us to love God with our whole selves, including the mind.

F 21. Christian meditation and abstinence are two steps in the *Lectio Divina*.
Christian contemplation

T 22. Jesus modeled spiritual disciplines such as solitude and prayer. _____

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points.]

Fill in the missing word(s) to complete each statement.

23. Spiritual disciplines are habits and practices that help form us to be more like Jesus.

24. Christian contemplation is resting quietly in the presence of God and his infinite love.

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25. When we worship, we are showing _____ reverence _____ or adoration for someone.
26. In _____ 1 Thessalonians 5:17 _____, Paul instructed believers to “pray without ceasing.”
27. “Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off everything that hinders and the sin that so easily entangles. And let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us.” (_____ Hebrews 12:1 _____)
28. _____ Worship _____ is a response to who God is, what he has done, and what he is doing.
29. The second step of the *Lectio Divina* is _____ meditate _____.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

30. Contrast what fasting is with what fasting is not.
Possible answer: Fasting is intentionally abstaining from food and drink, or abstaining from certain foods and drink for a set amount of time so you can give more attention to God. Fasting is not a display of holiness or an attempt to get God to do something for us or to earn his forgiveness. Dieting is also not fasting.
31. List and briefly describe the three types of fasts. Answers should include:
Defining Moment Fast: Fasting when we recognize that God is doing something new in our lives, or in response to a defining moment in our relationship with God.
Turning from Sinful Choices Fast: Fasting when we realize we’re living in sin, grieving over our actions, and repenting before God.
Tragic Calamity Fast: Fasting in response to tragedy and asking God to redeem it or to bring justice.
32. Explain three things the Lord’s Prayer teaches us about how to pray. Answers should include at least three of the following:
We learn that God wants us to address him as a loving parent while recognizing his holiness. We learn to seek what God desires and conform to his will.
We learn to trust God for our daily needs.
We learn to seek forgiveness, as well as to forgive those who have wronged us. We learn to ask God to bring us safely through trials and temptations.

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Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

33. Explain why people might avoid silence, what role technology plays in that avoidance, and what the benefits of silence are.

Possible answer: People probably avoid silence so that they don't have to face the truth about themselves. It's easier to ignore their consciences if they live a busy and noisy life. Technology can keep people so busy that they don't spend time getting to know God. Silence is beneficial because it helps Christians be honest with themselves and lets them focus on God without so many distractions.

34. Explain the benefits of reading widely, including books you disagree with. In your opinion, are there any types of books Christians should avoid? Why or why not?

Possible answer: Reading widely can help us learn things, especially from other Christians. Reading books we disagree with helps us test our ideas. If we are wrong, we can shift our perspective. If we are right, we can understand people we disagree with, treat more fairly and answer their arguments better.

Possible answer: I think Christians should avoid reading books that specifically teach us to do things that are against the Bible, like how to do palm reading or tell fortunes. If something causes us to sin, we should stay away from it.

35. Explain the difference between Eastern religion transcendence practices and the Christian spiritual disciplines.

Eastern religious transcendence practices try to get people to empty their minds so that they can be filled with something else. Christian spiritual disciplines encourage us to fill our minds with Scripture and to relate to God personally. As Christians, we don't turn off our minds. Instead, we use them to know and honor God more.